WEEK 10 · LECTURE L3 OF 3 · UNIT IV

Round 6: Future-of-Work Strategy

What a future-of-work HR strategy must cover, the 6B framework, and the Board Memo brief.

Part 1 What a future-of-work HR strategy must cover

Part 2 Automation exposure and the 6B framework

Part 3 The 1,500-word Board Memo brief

Read Manuti and de Palma (2018), Chapter 6; Westerman et al. (2014), strategy chapters

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PART 1 · WHAT THE STRATEGY MUST COVER

A future-of-work HR strategy answers five questions

Question	GreenLeaf evidence to use
Which work changes, and how fast?	Automation risk and skill gap by role family
Who does the work: employees, gig partners, machines?	300 gig partners; 6B classification
How do people move to new work?	Reskilling timelines; Bridge and Build paths
Is it fair to the least advantaged?	Bronze partners; Tier 3, smartphone-only staff
How will HR govern it?	Owners, metrics, review dates, the Board's stop rule

NOT A TOOL LIST

A strategy says who decides, how money flows and what is measured. A list of purchases is not a strategy.

PART 2 · AUTOMATION EXPOSURE

Which role families face the most change?

Role family	Full-scale headcount	Automation risk	Level	Skill gap	6B choice
Warehouse Operator	776	0.81	Critical	1.7	Bot
Care Executive	432	0.77	Critical	1.6	Bridge
Store Associate	1,776	0.74	High	1.4	Bridge
Procurement Assistant	184	0.72	High	1.1	Bridge
Inventory Executive	488	0.69	High	1.1	Bridge
Finance and Accounts Exec	80	0.66	High	1.1	Bridge

WATCH THE FILTER

Use Automation_Risk_Level, not a score above 0.70: a 0.70 filter silently drops two High families. Use Headcount_Fullscale_Est for the Board. Source: Workforce_Planning.

PART 2 · THE 6B FRAMEWORK

Six workforce responses

Response	Meaning
Build	Reskill internally
Buy	Hire externally
Borrow	Contract or partner
Bridge	Move to an adjacent role
Bot	Automate, with a transition plan (risk above 0.70 and a redeployment path)
Exit	Phase out through attrition

PART 3 · THE BOARD MEMO

What the 1,500-word memo must do

Lead with the ask

The decision, the money and the date, in the first paragraph.

Three reasons

Each backed by one dataset figure at full scale.

Risks and a counter metric

What could go wrong, and the measure that would show it.

Commitments

What HR will report, and when the Board can stop the program.

COHERENCE The memo should read as one thesis that grew across all six rounds, not six separate answers.

Going deeper: the theory underneath future-of-work strategy

The next slides set out Frey and Osborne and their critics, Acemoglu and Restrepo, and Lepak and Snell's HR architecture: what each claims, how it works, where it breaks, and what it means at GreenLeaf.

THEORY IN DEPTH · FREY AND OSBORNE (2017)

47% of US jobs at high risk of automation

THE CORE IDEA

They estimated the probability that each US occupation could be automated, finding 47% of jobs at high risk.

HOW IT WORKS

Experts labeled the automatability of 70 occupations; a model extended the estimates to 702.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Treating whole occupations as automatable overstates the risk.

AT GREENLEAF

GreenLeaf's risk scores apply to role families. Read them as exposure to change, not certain job loss.

THEORY IN DEPTH · ARNTZ, GREGORY AND ZIERAHN (2016)

Tasks, not occupations, are automated

THE CORE IDEA

Re-estimating at the task level, they found only about 9% of jobs across OECD countries highly automatable.

HOW IT WORKS

Workers within the same occupation do different task mixes, so many keep tasks machines cannot do.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Estimates depend on assumptions about future technology.

AT GREENLEAF

A Store Associate's job will be redesigned before it disappears. Plan the Bridge, not the Exit.

THEORY IN DEPTH · ACEMOGLU AND RESTREPO (2019)

Automation displaces, and new tasks reinstate

THE CORE IDEA

Technology has a displacement effect (machines take tasks) and a reinstatement effect (new tasks for people).

HOW IT WORKS

Whether labor's share rises or falls depends on the balance between them.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

In recent decades they find displacement has outpaced reinstatement.

AT GREENLEAF

GreenLeaf's strategy should name the new tasks it creates, such as data-quality ownership for HR officers.

THEORY IN DEPTH · LEPAK AND SNELL (1999)

Match the employment mode to the value and uniqueness of skills

THE CORE IDEA

The HR architecture: different kinds of human capital call for different employment modes.

HOW IT WORKS

High value and unique: develop internally. High value, generic: acquire. Low value, generic: contract. Low value, unique: alliance.

LIMITS AND CRITIQUE

Skills move between quadrants as technology changes.

AT GREENLEAF

The 6B framework maps onto this: Build for unique skills, Buy for valuable generic ones, Borrow for the rest.

TAKEAWAYS

Three things to carry out of this lecture

1

Filter by risk level and report at full scale.

2

Choose among Build, Buy, Borrow, Bridge, Bot and Exit with evidence.

3

Lead the Board Memo with one clear ask.

NEXT Strategy for resilience and agility.